

drag these along the timeline.

- **Graph editor**

Clicking this button brings up a graph editor instead of the time slider.

- **Advance**

Clicking the arrow advance the time by one frame

After keyframes for a particular scene are set, you can play back the animation.

You can play back directly in a viewport simply by clicking the Play button, located toward the bottom right corner of the 3ds Max interface.

- **Last Frame**

Goes to the end of the animation.

- **Back**

Steps back one frame.

- **First Frame**

Goes to the beginning of the animation.

- **Play**

Plays the animation.

- **Key Filters**

Determines the type of keys displayed on the time slider.

- **Key Mode**

Switches the forward and back buttons to move to the next key.

- **Set Key**

When the Set Key button is enabled; pressing the Key icon creates a key.

- **Current Time**

Displays the current time on the time slider. A new position can be typed in.

- **Time Configuration**

Brings up the Time Configuration window.

- **Curve Type**

Determines the type of curve when a key is set.

- **Forward**

Steps forward one frame.

7.3.2 Make Preview

Even on the fastest workstation, complex scenes often do not play back in a viewport in real time. This is when you need to use 3ds Max's Make Preview feature (choose Animation→Make Preview), which steps through the animation and renders a small movie file to disk that actually can be played back in real time.